

abate

abate *v.* to become less intense or widespread; to reduce something

aberration *n.* a departure from what is normal or expected

abhor *v.* to regard with disgust and hatred

abstain *v.* to choose not to do or take something

accolade *n.* an award, or an expression of praise

acumen *n.* sharp judgment and quick insight

adamant *adj.* refusing to be persuaded; unshakably firm

admonish *v.* to warn or reprimand gently but firmly

adversity *n.* a difficult or unpleasant situation

aesthetic *adj.* concerned with beauty, or with the appreciation of beauty

affable *adj.* friendly and easy to talk to

alleviate *v.* to make pain or a problem less severe

aloof *adj.* distant and uninvolved; emotionally cool

altruism *n.* unselfish concern for the welfare of others

ambiguous *adj.* open to more than one interpretation; unclear

ambivalent *adj.* having mixed or contradictory feelings about something